

Column

83

Why do our banks not notify us of data hacks and breaches in their database? The answer might surprise you.

Comparison test

84

We compare the dual cameras sported by the iPhone 7 Plus, Huawei P9 and Honor 8. Who won? Read on...

Bazaar

Apple iPhone 7 Plus

This is the ace

Apple's flagship phone has a dual-camera setup with two 12 MP main cameras that work in tandem and separately to present 2x optical zoom, along with improving image details and noise. The 12MP primary image sensor that accompanies the 28mm, f/1.8 wide angle lens is a 1/2.5-inch type CMOS sensor, and the 12 MP image sensor accompanying the 56mm, f/2.8 telephoto lens is a 1/3.6-inch type sensor.

The image sensors are typically smaller than those on the Galaxy S7, Pixel XL and LG G5, but Apple has aced noise cancellation and achieves optimum balance of light, colours, noise and sharpness in photographs. The iPhone 7 Plus shoots delightful photographs with very good colour accuracy and white balance. Photos are slightly warm, but still quite close to that of the source, details are crisp and subjects retain sharpness.

The iPhone also handles low light conditions well, keeping them relatively free of noise. Image noise is suppressed and the frame is brightly lit, with accurate colours.

Using the dual-camera setup, you can get up to 2x optical zoom from the wide angle camera. You can also use this for achieving background blurs. The bokeh mode hasn't hit the iPhones yet, but even without it, the 7 Plus produces gently blurred backgrounds.

The iPhone 7 Plus is also an incredible performer. It's blazing fast and switches between apps seamlessly, even when you're switching between apps like Email, Facebook, Google Snapseed, Google Maps and Asphalt 8. The app load times are noticeably faster than other smartphones, and benchmark scores put it ahead or at par with any flagship today.

The new quad-core A10 Fusion has two high performance cores, coupled with two low power cores. This brings its multi-core performance up to higher levels, and coupled with the vertical software-hardware integration, provides a



Price
₹72,000

seamless experience. There's really nothing as smooth as an iPhone thanks to the vertical integration. Interestingly, despite all this, the temperature of the iPhone never went past 39.3 degree Celsius, except when recording 4K video, which brought it to 41 degrees. These are acceptable levels, given the stress the phone is under.

Single core scores on Geekbench 4 come up to 3433, which is more than the Galaxy S7 Edge, Pixel XL and others. The multi-core performance, though, is more at par with other flagships. AnTuTu benchmark scores the iPhone 7 Plus, 171270, which again is higher than all others we've tested. The Google Pixel XL scores about 124k.

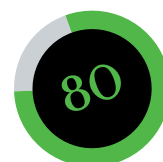
The 1080p display on the iPhone 7 Plus is warmer, looking pleasant.

The iPhone 7 Plus' major flaw is in design. Our matte black unit is quite heavily scratched, for no apparent reason. In addition, the design is not optimal for a 5.5 inch phone, any way. The iPhone 7 Plus is unwieldy and tough to manage. You definitely can't use it with one hand and it's quite heavy as well. Like the iPhone 7, you'll need a cover, which will make this bulkier.

You probably know about the lack of headphone jack on this phone. We're with you, it can be a hindrance. But in our testing, we felt the lack of the jack only once, when our Bluetooth headphones ran out of charge. There was no noticeable audio loss using Apple's in-box lightning to 3.5mm audio jack, and we were generally fine without the headphone jack. The stereo speakers do improve audio quality, but it's not better than the Sony Xperia Z5 or HTC 10. The iPhone uses the bottom right speaker grille and the earpiece output for stereo sound, which does improve overall audio.

The iPhone 7 Plus is one of the best phones in the market today. With over 24 hours of battery life on single charge, go for it – if you can.

Souvik Das



Features	67
Performance.....	96
Value	48
Design	89

Specifications

Display: 5.5 inch 1080p;
SoC: 2.23 GHz Apple A10 Fusion; **RAM:** 3GB;
Battery: 2900 mAh;
Storage: 32/128/256 GB;
Camera: 12MP dual-camera rear, 7MP front;
OS: iOS 10

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